

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

ALT this month:

Ever wondered what happens in the span of a minute on the internet? Wonder no more, just head to the Infoporn section. And if the internet was not toxic enough, head to Geek-Key to learn about the most poisonous substances on our planet. Finally, take a break from the madness with our DGT section.



Two temperatures at once?

Famous thought experiment Schrödinger's cat implied that a cat in a box could be both dead and alive at the same time. Physicists at the University of Exeter in England have found that a state of limbo similar to the famous thought experiment may exist for temperatures. In this limbo state, objects at the quantum level could be two temperatures at the same time.
<https://dgit.in/dnd4eva>

WHAT'S NEW

Did volcanic eruptions kill off the dinosaurs?

One of the most hotly debated topics in science is what caused the extinction of the dinosaurs. The most accepted theory at the moment is that the Cretaceous–Paleogene extinction event was caused by a 15 kilometre wide asteroid striking the Yucatán Peninsula in Mexico with a force of ten billion atomic bombs. However, not all scientists agree with this explanation, which they say is too convenient, and cannot really explain the scale of the global extinction event. Instead, the alternative theory is that the extinction was actually caused by a series of massive volcanic eruptions in India. According to the theory, massive eruptions



over a period of 60,000 years led to a "tipping point". The extinction is also gradual, and spread out over hundreds of thousands of years, with shrinking populations.

<https://dgit.in/dinogone>

How would detectives approach a murder on Mars?

When humans start colonising Mars, there will be a gradual build up of various facilities – propellant plants, launch complexes, mining facilities, greenhouses, habitats, communal areas and so on. With the build up of population and infrastructure, you can practically expect an increase in the number of crimes – including theft, sabotage and murder. The police and detectives on Mars have a lot of



experience on Earth, but their approaches will have to factor in various minutiae of life on Mars. For example, since the atmosphere is hostile to humans, a murder can easily be disguised as equipment malfunction or

spacesuit integrity failure. The forensics and the disintegration of bodies in the alien atmosphere will also be different, similar to the coldest areas on Earth. Then there is the remoteness of the potential crime scenes, when humans are just starting to populate the planet. It would be trivially easy to dispose off a body on such a vast planet, where they would not decompose practically forever.

<https://dgit.in/2NvNg5K>



Is it the beginning of the end for Facebook?

Facebook has been messing up a lot in the recent past. It has been used to interfere with elections, to spread weaponized disinformation, and incite violence against immigrants. The reaction? Users are spending increasingly less time on the social media platform.
<https://dgit.in/facend>



The giant crawling brain

Most studies into termites have centered around how to eradicate them, but some surprising new insights are exploring their usefulness. Instead of thinking of termite colonies as a hierarchy with queens, soldiers and workers, scientists are now thinking of them as parts of a single large brain.
<https://dgit.in/tbrain>



Humans are destroying animal knowledge

Like humans, animals also transfer knowledge from one generation to the next. This includes information on where food can be found, or migration routes. Thanks to shrinking populations, the individuals who can transfer this knowledge are disappearing off the Earth.
<https://dgit.in/animkno>